

ChineseWithHarry Free 20 Minute Daily Mandarin Blueprint

4 Pillars for consistent progress

You don't need hours a day to master Mandarin, you need consistency. 5 minutes a day on these 4 pillars will yield huge results over time.

The Core 4 Habits

Shadowing (Highest Priority)

- What - listen to a native audio clip and repeat it aloud after sentence-by-sentence, focusing on matching the speaker's rhythm, tone and pace as closely as possible
- Why - this trains your listening and speaking simultaneously. In order to successfully repeat, you must both understand the sentence and have a strong grasp of the tones and pronunciation rules

Flashcards - 5 minutes

- What - choose a deck of flashcards on quizlet or anki and go through learning them, using an AI to explain each word to you and use it in a sentence
- Why - this is the fastest way to build your vocabulary. Your entire language ability is dependent on how many words you know, so you need to be able to learn new words effectively

Input - 5 minutes

- What - listen to some content that a native would watch on a topic you enjoy. This can be through any format, but video is best for the visual cues, for example youtube, or rednote. Don't worry too much about understanding everything, just make sure you are going through and picking up any new words you learn and add them to a flashcard deck. The aim here is to accustom your ear to how natives actually communicate.
- Why - the aim here is to accustom your ear to how natives actually communicate, as well as building your vocabulary in the process. It's best to watch content you enjoy because you will be more engaged and you will be more likely to get into conversations where you talk about those topics.

Bonus: rednote, bilibili and iQiYi have tons of material so you will never run out of input.

Speaking - 5 minutes

- What - record a voice memo on your phone of you speaking for at least one minute. This can be about literally anything - your day, your favourite book, a friend etc. Then, you go back and listen to what you said and identify areas that you can improve. Examples could be your tones may not be accurate or you may not know how to say certain words.

- Why - the best way to improve your speaking is to speak more, but also to get feedback on your speaking. This method tackles both at once. While you may not be as good at giving feedback to yourself as a native speaker would, your training from the other parts will give you enough to be able to see the areas you need to improve on. I also highly recommend getting feedback from native speakers as often as you can.

The Gamification Matrix

Core Habit	Level 1: The minimum (20 minutes)	Level 2: The ideal (40 minutes)	Level 3: The committed (60 minutes)
Shadowing	5	10	15
Flashcards	5	10	15
Input	5	10	15
Output	5	10	15

Start with Level 1. 20 minutes is short enough to beat procrastination, but long enough to yield visible results. Focus on locking in the daily habit first, that's the most important part. Once that feels comfortable, scale up to Level 2 or 3. If you are short on time, always prioritise shadowing and flashcards. Always remember, something is better than nothing. If you are really tight on time one day and you definitely won't be able to do even 20 minutes, see if you can make room for 5. Keep the habit alive.

To make the habit stick, try to do it at the same time and place every day, and stack it on top of another habit. For example, do it at your desk every morning after you brush your teeth.

Stop Wasting Time On Apps That Don't Work

Most language apps rely on matching games and repetitive grammar drills. They don't actually teach you how to acquire fluency.

We are building a Mandarin learning app designed to break you free from these slow, traditional methods. Instead, we focus on how the brain actually absorbs mandarin, giving you a streamlined path to fluency in less time.

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